



Minibeasts

You can spot small creatures called minibeasts if you crouch close to the ground. These include marching ants, scuttling centipedes, and gliding slugs.

Centipedes hunt insects and slugs by pouncing and injecting venom from their legs.

Mesofauna

There are tens of thousands of tiny, dot-sized soil animals called mesofauna. These include sprinting mites and leaping springtails.

Burrowing creatures bulldoze or dig their way through soil.

Microorganisms are an important part of the earthworm diet.

Microorganisms

The smallest soil dwellers are microorganisms. A microscope is needed to see almost all the bacteria and fungi that make up this group. There are billions of them in one spadeful of soil.

Most millipedes have fewer than 100 legs.